SITE FOUNDATIONS · V0.2 · OCTOBER 2026

THEME LIGHT SYSTEM DARK

How Richard's research site is put together.

Type, colour, layout, components and voice for a five-page site covering the book, the Tallersol archive, the Migration, Music and Memory project, and the publications list.

This version brings the v0.1 foundations and the proposal sent to Richard into one document, and brings both into line with the first build. The built values were read back from the live page on 16 October 2026 (register item 11), so this is now the reference rather than a set of proposals. v0.1 and the first-draft proposal move to `_Superseded`.

Where the look comes from

The colours are taken from screen-printed protest posters of the kind Tallersol produced: flat red and yellow ink on warm paper. The page around them stays quiet so the research is what people read, and the posters themselves, when they appear, aren't competing with the design.

Most visitors will be other academics and archivists, with some journalists and people from the communities Richard works with.

READ FIRST

What changed in v0.2

One document now holds everything: the v0.1 foundations, the proposal's pages, voice, image rules and accessibility statement, and what the first build taught. What moved:

1. **Two boxes, named.** The book (sun) and each year's publications (paper raised) are the only boxed items. Everything else is rules and space. This settles v0.1's clash between "panels and the citation box" and "not boxes".
2. **Dark palette redone.** The same inks, deepened instead of lightened: red stays red, the blue stays teal, and the yellow block is a darker ochre. New fixed ink, `--on-sun`, for text on it. The page ground is deeper and the raised panel lifted, so the citation box stands out against it.
3. **Publication titles** are 18px regular in quotes, as the proposal and v0.1's own specimen showed. The 21px semibold style is for project titles and the book.
4. **Phone menu** is a burger below 640px. v0.1 said no hamburger.
5. **Footer** is three lines at every size, and gains the Light / System / Dark slider.
6. **The link arrow is drawn,** not typed. iOS turns the ↗ character into a blue emoji. The arrow stays on the line with its word.
7. **Line length.** The 720px column stands; the 62–70 character target is dropped and logged as open item 15.
8. **Contrast** recalculated for both themes and both grounds. The proposal's "about 9:1" for red on paper was wrong; it is 5.8 : 1.
9. **Pages, voice, images and accessibility** from the proposal are now sections 01, 02, 07 and 09.
10. **Values read back.** Register item 10 of v0.1 is closed; the differences are tabled in section 10.

01 — PAGES

Five pages

Content changes a few times a year, so the site is a simple static build with no CMS. Hosting stays cheap and there is very little to break. When there is something new, Richard sends it to Miles and Miles adds it. The wordmark is the link to Home; the menu carries the other four.

Home

A sentence on what Richard works on, the book as the featured item, the two live projects and the three most recent outputs.

Research

The PhD and book, and what Richard is working on now.

Publications

Newest first, grouped by year, with DOI and repository links.

Projects

Tallersol: Memories of Resistance, and Migration, Music and Memory. This is where the poster images live.

About

The route from chemistry to history, qualifications in full, contact details, and links to ORCID, Scholar, Academia, Bluesky and LinkedIn.

A Talks or Teaching page can be added later if there is enough to fill it. Shell widths and what each page holds are in section 07.

02 — VOICE

Writing for the site

- The site speaks as Richard, in the first person, in plain British English with short paragraphs.
- Spanish names keep their accents (Tallersol, Universidad de Chile, Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile) and are marked up with `lang="es"` so screen readers pronounce them properly.
- Name the collaborators wherever they come up: Professor Sara Cohen and Professor Lisa Shaw, Tallersol, Merseyside's Chilean community. So much of the current work is joint that leaving them out would give the wrong picture.
- Book titles in italics. Article titles in plain text with quotation marks. Journal names in the muted colour, in the meta line.
- No emoji or exclamation marks. Avoid "passionate about".

The site launches in English with a short Spanish summary on About. Whether a full Spanish version is worth it is Richard's call (register item 12).

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03 — WORDMARK

The name, set in type

There's no logo and the site doesn't need one. The wordmark is the name set in Archivo Narrow 700, with the middle initial.

Richard G. Smith

ON PAPER · LIGHT

Richard G. Smith

ON PAPER · DARK

RGS

FAVICON · INK ON SUN

Use

- Ink on paper in both themes. It always takes the text colour, never the accent.
- The initials **RGS** on a sun square for the favicon and social avatar, where the full name won't fit.
- Plain text in the HTML, so it stays selectable and screen readers say the name.

Don't

- Set the name in poster red, or put it on a red or blue fill.
- Add the post-nominals to the masthead. They belong on the About page, written out once.
- Turn it into an image or draw a mark around it.

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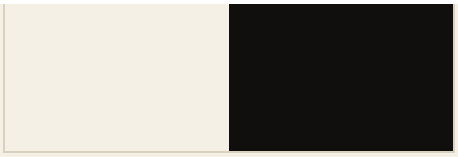
04 — COLOUR

Palette

Warm paper and ink, one red accent, a blue that belongs to the music project, and a yellow that's only ever a fill. Every colour has a dark-theme value, and the site follows the visitor's light or dark setting. Each chip shows light on the left and dark on the right.

Every page sits on the paper colour, never pure white. Red is the only real accent and is used sparingly: links, the current menu item and year markers. Blue belongs to the music and memory project and to topic tags. Yellow appears as a fill at most once a page, with dark text on it.

In dark mode the same inks are kept but deepened, not lightened. Red stays red, the blue stays teal, and the yellow block turns a darker ochre instead of glowing against the dark page.

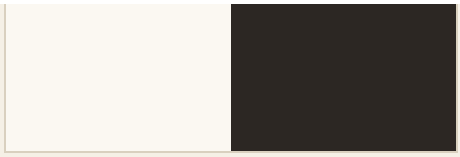


LIGHT DARK

Paper

#F5F0E6 · #110F0D

Page background. Never pure white or black.



LIGHT DARK

Paper raised

#FBF8F2 · #2C2723

The citation box. The only other panel colour. Lifted in dark so the box stands out.

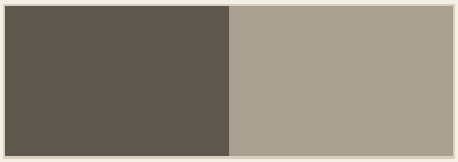


LIGHT DARK

Ink

#1E1B18 · #E6DFD0

Headings, body copy, the wordmark.

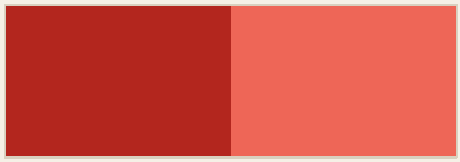


LIGHT DARK

Muted

#5E574E · #A8A090

Dates, journal names, captions, labels.

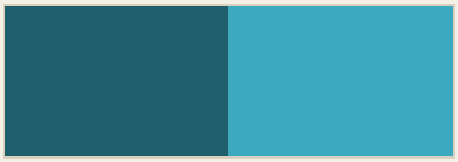


LIGHT DARK

Poster red

#B3261E · #EE6657

Links, the current page, year markers.

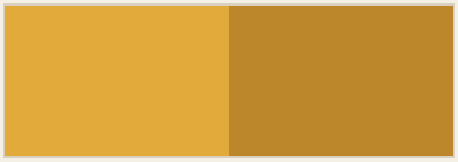


LIGHT DARK

Andes blue

#1F5F6B · #3DA9BF

Topic tags and the music and memory project.



LIGHT DARK

Sun

#E2A93B · #BC862A

Fill only, at most once a page, ink text on it.



LIGHT DARK

On sun `--on-sun`

#1E1B18 · #1E1B18

Text on the sun block. Fixed dark in both themes.



LIGHT DARK

Rule

#D9D0BF · #403931

Hairlines between sections and entries.

TEXT ON GROUND	LIGHT, PAPER	LIGHT, RAISED	DARK, PAPER	DARK, RAISED	USED FOR
Ink	15.1	16.2	14.4	11.1	All body copy and headings
Muted	6.3	6.7	7.4	5.7	Metadata and captions
Poster red	5.8	6.2	6.1	4.7	Links, year markers

Andes blue	6.4	6.8	6.9	5.4	Tags
On-sun ink on sun	8.1	–	5.4	–	The featured book block
Paper on Andes blue	6.4	–	6.9	–	A selected filter tag
Paper on ink	15.1	–	14.4	–	The chosen stop of the theme slider

Every pair clears WCAG AA (4.5 : 1) in both themes; the lowest is poster red on raised in dark, 4.7 : 1. Raised is slightly lower than paper in dark and slightly higher in light. Red on sun is never used (3.1 : 1 light, 1.2 : 1 dark), so focus on the book block is drawn in ink.

05 — TYPOGRAPHY

Two faces, split by job

Archivo Narrow does the signage: the wordmark, headings, navigation and labels. Newsreader does everything people read. Both are free on Google Fonts under the SIL Open Font Licence.

Aa

ARCHIVO NARROW · HEADINGS & INTERFACE · 600 / 700

Memories of Resistance

Condensed and bold, close to the hand-cut lettering on the posters. Used sparingly: it runs the structure of the page and never sets a paragraph.

600
Section heads, nav, labels, tags

700
Wordmark, page titles, year markers

Aa

NEWSREADER · READING · 400 / 400 ITALIC / 600

Tallersol is a graphic workshop founded in Santiago in 1977, and its posters are being digitised for researchers, campaigners and the public.

A text serif designed for long reading on screen. 18px body on a 30px line. Italic is for book titles and captions; 600 for project titles; regular for everything else, publication titles included.

400
Body, lede, metadata

400 italic
Book titles, captions

600
Project titles

06 — HEADS

The scale

Every level the site will use, at true size beside its spec. Display sizes step down below 640px; everything else stays put.

Richard G. Smith

WORDMARK
Archivo Narrow 700 · 22px / 1.0 · tracking 0.01em · ink

RESEARCH PUBLICATIONS PROJECTS ABOUT

NAV LINK
Archivo Narrow 600 · 15px / 1.6 · tracking 0.04em · uppercase · ink. Current page goes poster red with a 2px underline.

Student

PAGE TITLE · H1

resistance in Chile

Archivo Narrow 700 · 52px / 54px · tracking –0.01em · ink. 36px / 40px below 640px. One per page.

Recent work

SECTION HEAD · H2
Archivo Narrow 600 · 30px / 36px · ink. 26px / 32px below 640px.

2025

YEAR MARKER
Archivo Narrow 700 · 30px / 36px · poster red. Publications page only.

Music, migration and identity in Liverpool

ITEM TITLE · H3
Newsreader 600 · 21px / 28px · ink. Project titles in lists; the book title in the featured block (italic).

“Legacies of the 1973 Coup in Chile: Music, Identity and Resistance”

PUBLICATION TITLE
Newsreader 400 · 18px / 28px · ink · roman, in double quotes. Inside the citation box.

RECENT WORK

EYEBROW
Archivo Narrow 600 · 13px / 18px · tracking 0.06em · uppercase · muted. Never a full sentence.

A historian of student resistance to the Pinochet dictatorship and of music in Chilean exile.

LEDE
Newsreader 400 · 21px / 32px · ink. First paragraph on Home and Research only.

The collection provides insight into the networks and strategies of urban social movements in Chile in the late 1970s and 1980s.

BODY
Newsreader 400 · 18px / 30px · ink · paragraph gap 16px · the 720px column

holds about 90–95 characters at this size, so keep paragraphs short

Cohen, Shaw and Smith · *Bulletin of Hispanic Studies* 102(6)

CITATION & META
Newsreader 400 · 15px / 24px · muted. Journal and book titles in italic.

Poster title, year. Tallersol, Santiago.

CAPTION
Newsreader 400 italic · 15px / 24px · muted

Exile

TAG
Archivo Narrow 600 · 13px / 18px · tracking 0.04em · andes blue · 1px border · 999px radius

RICHARD G. SMITH · UNIVERSITY OF LIVERPOOL

FOOTER
Archivo Narrow 600 · 13px / 22px · tracking 0.06em · uppercase · muted

LEVEL	FACE	SIZE	LINE	TRACKING	COLOUR
Wordmark	Archivo Narrow 700	22px	1.0	0.01em	ink
Nav link	Archivo Narrow 600	15px	1.6	0.04em	ink / red
H1	Archivo Narrow 700	52px (36px)	54px (40px)	−0.01em	ink
H2	Archivo Narrow 600	30px (26px)	36px (32px)	normal	ink
Year marker	Archivo Narrow 700	30px	36px	normal	red
H3 / book title (italic)	Newsreader 600	21px	28px	normal	ink
Publication title	Newsreader 400	18px	28px	normal	ink
Eyebrow	Archivo Narrow 600	13px	18px	0.06em	muted

Lede	Newsreader 400	21px	32px	normal	ink
Body	Newsreader 400	18px	30px	normal	ink
Meta	Newsreader 400	15px	24px	normal	muted
Caption	Newsreader 400 italic	15px	24px	normal	muted
Tag	Archivo Narrow 600	13px	18px	0.04em	blue
Footer	Archivo Narrow 600	13px	22px	0.06em	muted

Bracketed values apply below 640px. Tracking only appears on uppercase Archivo Narrow; if something in Newsreader is tracked, it's off-house. Tags are 3px 10px of padding, which keeps them 26px tall (WCAG 2.2 asks for at least 24px).

07 — LAYOUT

Two shells, four spacing steps

Reading pages sit in a 720px column. Projects and Publications widen to 960px: Projects for a two-column grid of cards, Publications so each year's box can set the year beside its entries. Both drop to one column on phones. All spacing comes from four steps, and nothing is set between them.

960 · masthead, footer, Projects grid, Publications

720 · Home, Research, About, project pages

TOKEN	VALUE	USED FOR
--space-1	8px	Title to metadata; gap between tags
--space-2	16px	Paragraph gap; either side of an entry's hairline (16 + 16); side gutter on phones

`--space-3`	32px	Between citation boxes; panel padding (the book, each box); side gutter from 640px
`--space-4`	64px	Between page sections
`--measure`	720px	Reading column
`--wide`	960px	Grids and chrome

PAGE	SHELL	HOLDS
Home	720	Lede, the book on a sun block, the two projects, the three most recent outputs in a citation box
Research	720	The PhD and book, current work
Publications	960	Newest first, one citation box per year, topic filter, DOI and repository links
Projects	960 → 720	Two-card index, then a reading page per project with posters
About	720	Background, qualifications in full, profile links, contact, one portrait

BREAKPOINT	WHAT CHANGES
960px	Wide shell reaches its maximum; gutters grow from here
720px	Two-column grids, and the year-beside-entries layout, drop to one column
640px	H1 52→36px, H2 30→26px; the menu folds behind the burger; side gutter 32→16px
prefers-color-scheme	Dark palette swaps in, unless the visitor has chosen Light or Dark on the slider
prefers-reduced-motion	Honoured. The only motion is the slider's thumb, and it stops.

Boxes

Only two things on the site sit in boxes. Every box is square, with no border and no shadow, 32px of padding inside, 32px from the next box, and never holds another box. Everything else is separated by hairline rules and space.

Boxed

- The book: a `--sun` block, Home only, ink text.
- Each year's publications: a `--paper-raised` citation box with the red year inside it. Used on Publications, in Home's recent work, and in a project's related publications.

Not boxed

- Project cards: a 4px bar, an eyebrow, a title and a line.
- Poster figures and the portrait: the image, then a caption.
- Page sections, the masthead, the footer, notes and links.

The raised panels in this document that hold specimens are the document's own furniture, not site components.

Page and image rules

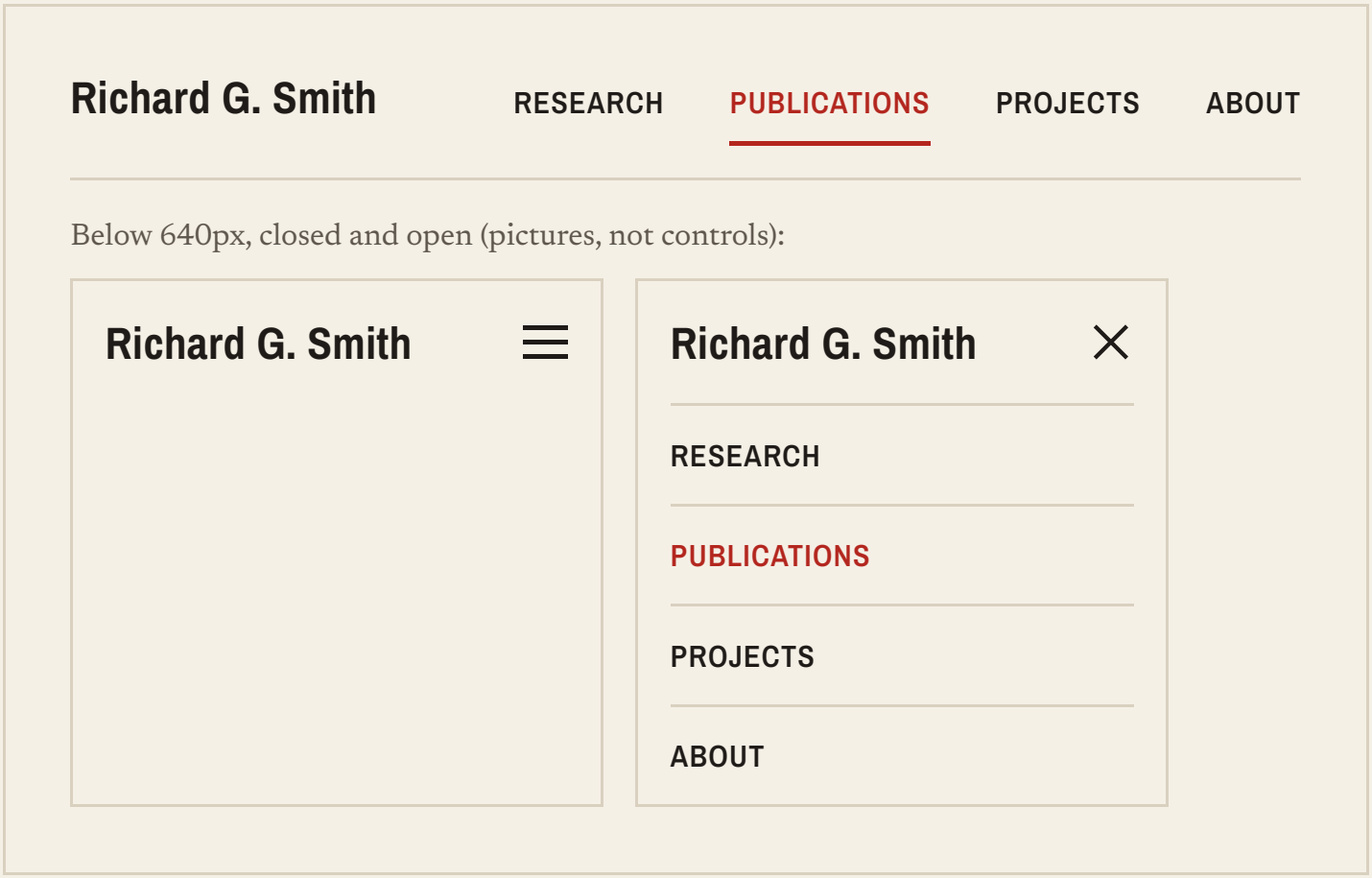
- One column, no wider than 720px, on reading pages. Publications and Projects widen to 960px and drop back to one column on phones.
- Square corners on images, cards and buttons, as on printed matter. Rounded ends only on topic tags; the focus ring is the one other rounded thing.
- Sections are separated by thin rules and space. No shadows.
- Posters are shown only with Tallersol's permission, each captioned with title, year and source, and the site links out to the UCLA archive rather than copying the collection.
- Archive images are shown as they are, with no filters. There is one portrait of Richard, on About, and no stock photos anywhere.
- No icon set. Profile links are plain text, and any link that leaves the site carries a small arrow.

08 — COMPONENTS

The working parts

Eight components carry the whole site. Each one is shown live at its real values; hover the nav, tags and links to see their states, or tab through to see focus. The slider works on this page: try it.

Masthead & nav



- Sits on paper, not a raised panel, with a rule hairline beneath. The wordmark is always ink and links to Home.
- From 640px the four links sit inline, 32px apart. The current page is marked with `aria-current="page"`, poster red and a 2px underline. Hover shows the underline in rule colour only.
- Below 640px the links fold behind a burger: three flat bars in a 44px target named "Menu" (`aria-`

expanded) that turn into a cross when open. The menu opens as full-width rows divided by hairlines. Escape closes it and returns focus to the button.
- With JavaScript off there is no burger. The four links just show in one row.

Featured book

THE BOOK

Student Resistance to Dictatorship in Chile, 1973–1990

Springer, 2024 · Publisher's page ↗

- The one use of sun as a fill, and the first of the two boxes. Home page only.
- Text on it is always `--on-sun` ink, in both themes. Links on it are ink with an underline, not red, and focus is drawn in ink.
- The title is the H3 style in italic (21px / 28px). 32px of padding, 16px below 640px.
- Square corners, no border, no shadow.

Publication entry and citation box

All | Exile | Merseyside | Music

2025

"Legacies of the 1973 Coup in Chile: Music, Identity and Resistance"

Cohen, Shaw and Smith · *Bulletin of Hispanic Studies* 102(6) · DOI ↗

- The second of the two boxes: a raised panel per year, newest first, with the red year marker at the top. Boxes stack 32px apart. From 720px the year sits to the left of the entries.
- Entries are divided by a hairline with 16px either side, so 32px in all.
- Article title in roman with double quotes, 18px; journal and book titles italic in the meta line. Co-authors in the order the journal prints them.
- Links go to the DOI, plus the Liverpool

Music Exile

"The Role of Music in the UK's Chile Solidarity Campaign and in Developing an Exile's Sense of Self and Place"

Carrasco and Smith · *Bulletin of Hispanic Studies* 102(6) · DOI ↗

Music Merseyside

repository copy where there is one. Both open in a new tab and carry the arrow.

- The tags on an entry are labels. The same tags sit above the list as filter buttons (hidden without JavaScript): choosing one hides other entries and any box left empty, and says how many remain. Hover fills a button blue, and so does the chosen one.

Project card

ARCHIVE · 2021–2026

Tallersol: Memories of Resistance

Digitising the Tallersol poster collection with UCLA's Modern Endangered Archives Program.

COMMUNITY · ONGOING

Migration, Music and Memory

With Sara Cohen and Lisa Shaw, working with Chilean, Yemeni and Ukrainian communities in Liverpool.

- A 4px top bar marks the strand: poster red for the archive, Andes blue for music and memory. It's the only place the bar appears.
- No fill, no border: not a box. The card is the bar, an eyebrow, a title and one line of meta text.
- The whole card is the link, with the title underlined on hover.

Poster figure

POSTER IMAGE

3 : 4 · NO FILTER

Title, year. Tallersol, Santiago. Courtesy of the Memories of Resistance archive.

- Shown exactly as scanned, with no tint, duotone or crop to a different ratio.
- Every image has a caption with title, year and source, and alt text that says what the poster shows and what it campaigned for.
- Square corners, no frame. The dashed box here is a placeholder only; in the build the stand-in is a flat grey 3 : 4 box labelled "Poster image".
- Lazy-loaded, with paper raised showing while it loads. The same figure holds the portrait on About.

Body link & focus

The collection is held at UCLA as Memories of Resistance ↗, and parts of it were shown at the British Library in September 2023.

- Poster red, underlined at a 3px offset. Hover thickens the underline to 2px.
- Focus is a solid 2px poster red outline, 2px offset, 2px radius. It's the only rounded corner outside the tags. On the sun block it is drawn in ink.
- A link that leaves the site carries a small arrow after the text and opens in a new tab.
- The arrow is drawn, not typed: iOS replaces the ↗ character with a blue

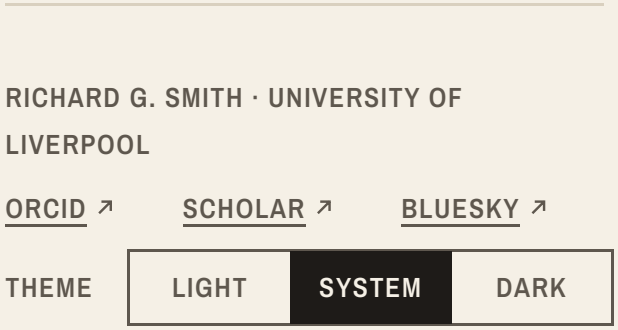
emoji. The last word and the arrow are kept together so the arrow never sits alone on a line.

Theme slider



- Three stops, Light, System and Dark, with a square ink thumb that slides to the chosen one. System is the middle stop and the default: it follows the visitor's device.
- Light and Dark override the device. The choice is remembered in that browser only, and applied before the page paints so there is no flash.
- Built on radio buttons: arrow keys, screen readers and a tap anywhere on a stop all work. The chosen label flips to paper on the ink thumb. Hidden when JavaScript is off.

Footer



- Three lines at every width: who it is, the profile links, the theme slider. Each stays on one line down to 320px. Rule hairline above, 32px of padding.
- Profile links as plain text, no icons. No copyright line and no repeat of the nav.

09 — ACCESSIBILITY

Contrast and the basics

Every text colour is checked against WCAG AA on the grounds it sits on, in light and dark (section 04). The weakest text pairing anywhere is 4.7 : 1. Keyboard focus shows as a 2px poster red outline. Each poster's alt text says what it shows and what it was campaigning for. The site follows the visitor's light or dark setting unless they choose otherwise.

- One H1 per page, a skip link to the main content, and `lang="en-GB"` on the page with `lang="es"` on Spanish names.
- Every image has an alt text slot. Tap and click targets are at least 24px; the menu button is 44px.
- The menu and the theme slider work from the keyboard, and with reduced motion the slider's thumb jumps instead of sliding.
- The page works from 360px up with no sideways scrolling. With JavaScript off, the links show and the slider and filter are hidden.

10 — REGISTER

Decisions & open questions

Settled decisions first, so nobody "fixes" them later. The open items are the ones to settle with Richard before or during the build.

01 — Light and dark, both designed SETTLED

The site follows the visitor's setting, and a Light / System / Dark slider in the footer lets anyone override it, remembered in that browser only. Dark is a deep warm paper (#110F0D) rather than pure black, and every token has a value for it. The dark inks are deepened rather than lightened (section 04).

02 — One accent SETTLED

Poster red is the only accent and stays small. Andes blue belongs to the music and memory strand and tags. Sun is a fill, used once, on the book.

03 — History and music only SETTLED

The publications list covers the history and music work. Earlier work in other fields isn't listed.

04 — Square, flat, and two boxes SETTLED

No shadows anywhere, square corners on everything except tags and the focus ring. Sections are separated by rules and space. Only two things sit in boxes: the book (sun) and each year's publications (paper raised). A box never holds another box.

05 — Posters by permission SETTLED

A small selection only, with Tallersol's agreement and a credit under each one. The full collection is linked at UCLA, not re-hosted.

06 — Spanish names as written SETTLED

Accents kept (Universidad de Chile, Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile) and marked up with `lang="es"` so screen readers pronounce them properly.

07 — Phone menu SETTLED

Below 640px the four links fold behind a burger button; from 640px they sit inline. This replaces v0.1's "no hamburger menu". With JavaScript off the links simply show.

08 — Theme slider SETTLED

A three-stop slider (Light, System, Dark) in the footer, System in the middle and the default. Built on radio buttons so keyboard and screen readers work natively; hidden when JavaScript is off.

09 — Publication titles SETTLED

Eighteen pixels, regular, in double quotes, as the proposal and v0.1's own specimen showed. The 21px semibold style is for project titles; the book title is that style in italic.

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10 — Link arrow SETTLED

Drawn, not typed: iOS replaces the ↗ character with a blue emoji. It stays on the line with the last word of its link.

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11 — Values read back SETTLED

Done 16 October 2026. The built site was read back against sections 05 to 08: 15 of 16 type rows matched exactly (the 16th, the eyebrow inside the book block, is ink on purpose), and the differences are in the table below. They are now the spec.

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12 — Spanish version OPEN

A short Spanish summary on About is planned for launch. Whether the whole site should also be in Spanish is Richard's call; it roughly doubles every future update.

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13 — Portrait OPEN

One photo of Richard for About. None chosen yet. Natural light, no studio backdrop, no filter. A grey placeholder slot is built.

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14 — Domain OPEN

Not registered. The favicon and social card wait on it.

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15 — Line length OPEN

The 720px column holds about 90–95 characters at 18px, longer than the 62–70 that v0.1 asked for. The column is kept because the proposal promised it, and short paragraphs (see Voice) carry the load. If long passages read heavy once real text is in, cap paragraphs at about 30em.

Read back from the build, 16 October 2026

Where the built site differs from v0.1, and what this guide now says. Everything else in

sections 05 to 08 matched as written.

ITEM	V0.1 SAID	NOW
Dark palette	paper #1A1714, ink #EDE6D8, muted #B5AC9D, red #F07A6A, blue #7FC1CC, sun #D9A040, raised #24201C, rule #3A342D	paper #110F0D, ink #E6DFD0, muted #A8A090, red #EE6657, blue #3DA9BF, sun #BC862A, raised #2C2723 (the box, lifted so it stands out), rule #403931
Publication title	21px semibold in the type table; 18px regular in the specimen	18px / 28px regular, in quotes
Book title	24px / 30px italic in the specimen; no row in the table	21px / 28px italic semibold (the H3 style)
Tag padding	2px 10px	3px 10px, so tags are 26px tall
Nav link spacing	16px in the specimen	32px from 640px; 8px if the links stay in one row without JavaScript
Footer	one wrapping line	three lines
Phone menu	no hamburger; links wrap under the wordmark	burger below 640px
Measure	62–70 characters	about 90–95 (open item 15)

SITE	Domain not yet registered. Built as a static Astro site.
VERSION	v0.2, October 2026. Supersedes v0.1 and the first-draft proposal.
OWNER	Dr Richard G. Smith, Honorary Research Fellow, Music, University of Liverpool
DISPLAY FACE	Archivo Narrow, Google Fonts, SIL OFL

TEXT FACE	Newsreader, Google Fonts, SIL OFL
PROFILES	ORCID 0000-0001-5894-4600 · Google Scholar · Academia · Bluesky · LinkedIn

Miles Roberts · Site foundations for Richard G. Smith, v0.2, October 2026. Values were read back from the first build on 16 October 2026. Publications are taken from Richard's University of Liverpool staff page. The page is self-contained apart from the two web fonts. This page is published on the site at an unlinked address, `/styleguide/`, and is kept out of search engines. Back to the site.